

UNICELLULAR ORGANISMS

Structures matter

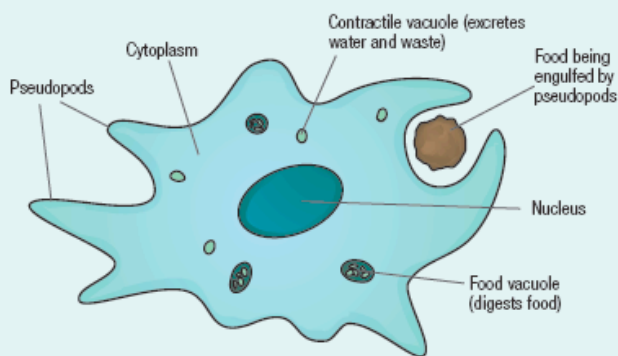
Form and function

Protists are an extremely diverse group of organisms that are mostly unicellular. Many live in water, some are photosynthetic (i.e. make their own food, like plants), some are herbivores and some are parasites. Depending on the lifestyle and food source of the organism, the form or structure of its cell will have evolved to suit.

The following protists have structures particular to their lifestyles.

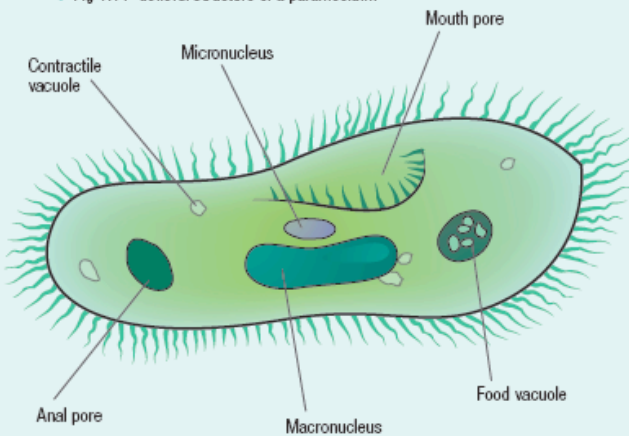
- 1 An *amoeba* can change the shape of its blobby body, creating foot shapes for movement and mouth shapes for swallowing food.

→ Fig 1.10 General structure of an amoeba.



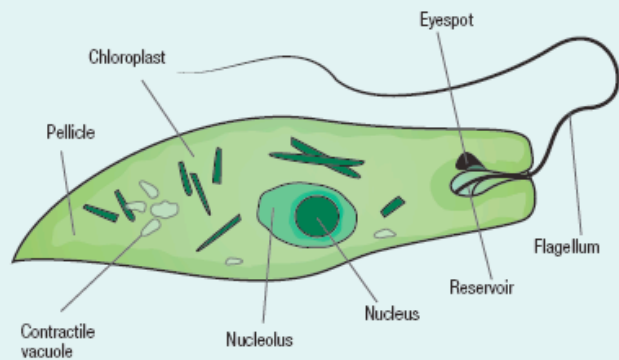
- 2 The *paramecium* plods along slowly with lots of tiny hairs called cilia that act like miniature oars.

→ Fig 1.11 General structure of a paramecium.



- 3 *Euglena* moves really quickly when it needs to, with a bullet-shaped body and a long tail called a flagellum to whip it into action.

→ Fig 1.12 General structure of euglena.



- 4 *Chlamydomonas* has an eye spot that can detect light for photosynthesis and two flagella that help it swim along in a breaststroke-like motion.

→ Fig 1.13 General structure of chlamydomonas.

